

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Circles	Hard

Question

A circle in the xy -plane has its center at $(19, 18)$ and has a radius of $9k$. Which equation represents this circle?

Answer

- A. $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = 81k$
- B. $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = 81k^2$
- C. $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = 9k$
- D. $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = 9k^2$

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. The equation of a circle in the xy -plane can be written as $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$, where the center of the circle is (h, k) and the radius of the circle is r . It's given that this circle has a center at $(19, 18)$ and a radius of $9k$. Substituting 19 for h , 18 for k , and $9k$ for r in $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$ yields $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = (9k)^2$, or $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = 81k^2$. Therefore, the equation that represents this circle is $(x - 19)^2 + (y - 18)^2 = 81k^2$.

Choice A is incorrect. This equation represents a circle with radius $9\sqrt{k}$, not $9k$.

Choice C is incorrect. This equation represents a circle with radius $\sqrt{9k}$, not $9k$.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation represents a circle with radius $\sqrt{9k}$, not $9k$.